LEWIS BUENAVENTURA

TWO ANALYSTS. SAME DEGREE. $50K APART.

What 2,251 job postings reveal about the data analyst salary market

Analyst A

$42,000

Sector	**Insurance**
Site	**Florida**
Skills	**SAS + Excel**

Same title, same degree.

Analyst A

$42,000

Sector	**Insurance**
Site	**Florida**
Skills	**SAS + Excel**

Analyst B

$92,000

Sector	**Biotech**
Site	**California**
Skills	**Python + SQL**

$50k gap. That gap follows patterns.

Analyst A

$42,000

Sector	**Insurance**
Site	**Florida**
Skills	**SAS + Excel**

$50K gap

Analyst B

$92,000

Sector	**Biotech**
Site	**California**
Skills	**Python + SQL**

2,251 postings | **$69k** median | **20** US states | **85** sectors

Which determines salary?

Q1

Does your sector set your salary floor?

Q2

Which skills actually move your salary?

Q3

Does company site change the equation?

Q1

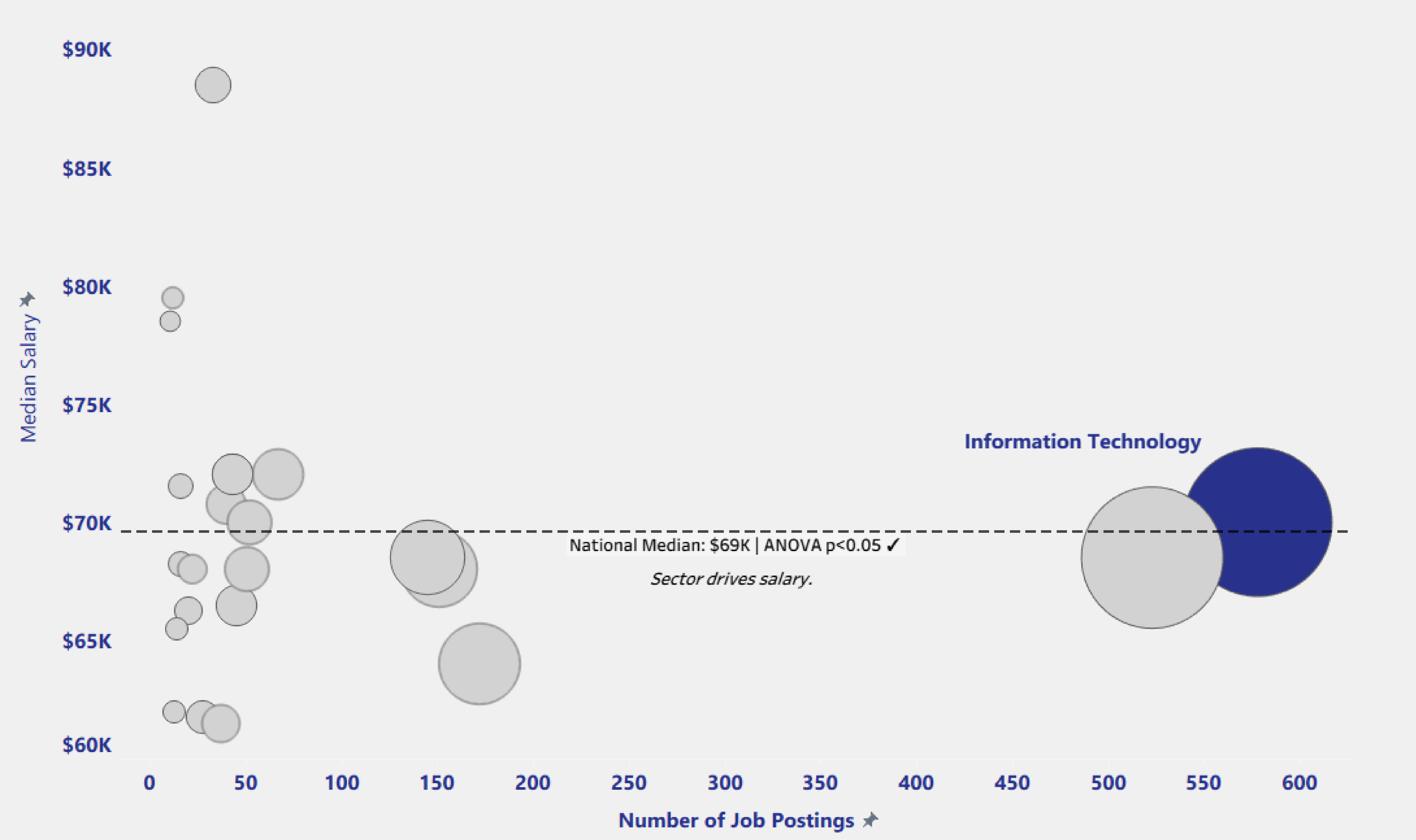
Does your sector set your salary floor?

THE MYTH: SECTOR

"Get into **Tech,** they have the **most jobs** and **pay the best**.”

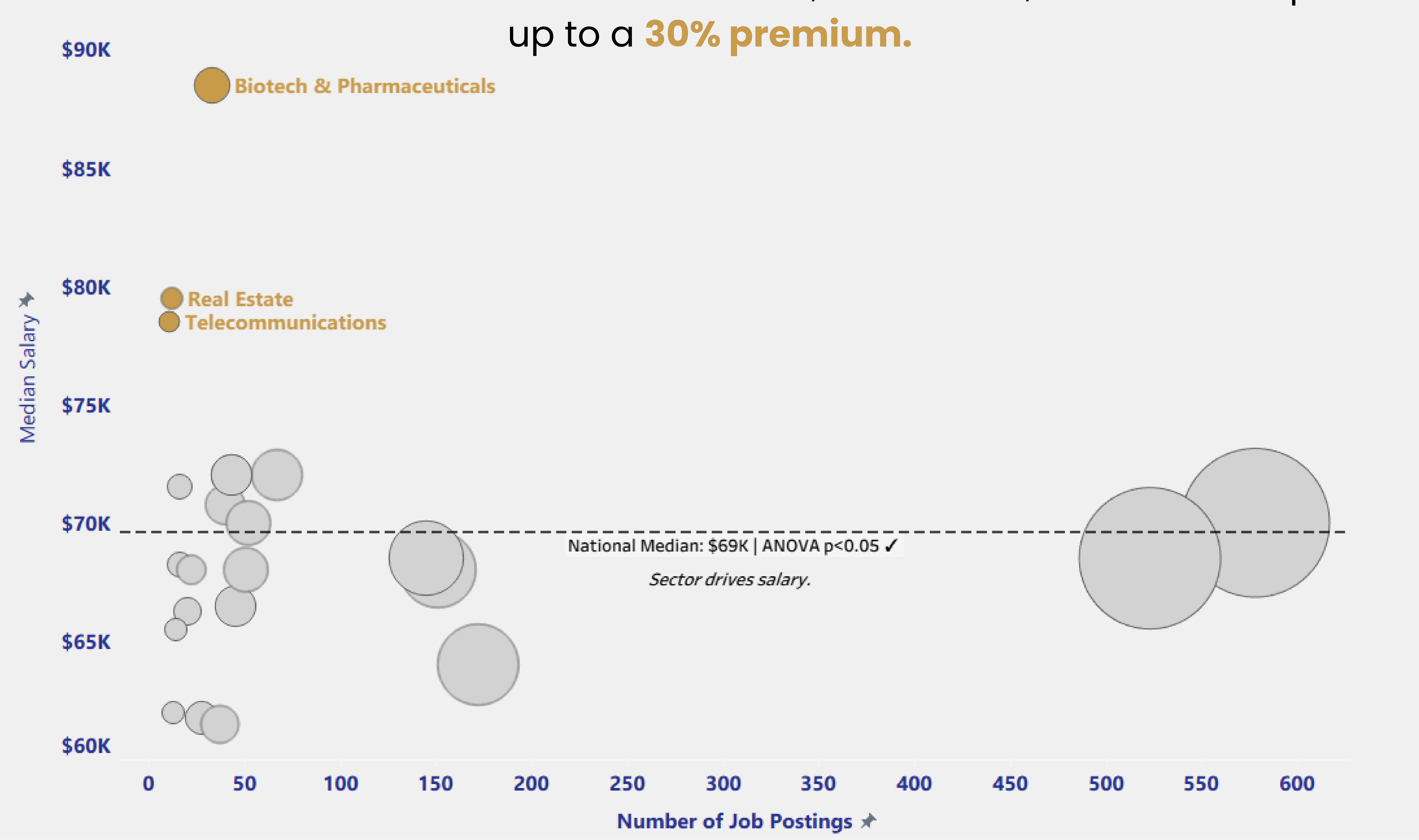
Sector: More Jobs ≠ Better Pay:

IT has 570 postings but earns near the **median**



Sector: More Jobs ≠ Better Pay:

Niche Sectors like Biotech & Pharmaceuticals, Real Estate, and Telecom provide up to a **30% premium.**



Q1

Does your sector set your salary floor?

YES, SECTOR SETS YOUR FLOOR.
SKILLS DETERMINE HOW FAR ABOVE IT YOU CAN CLIMB.

*Your **sector** choice is worth **$19,500** a year before you write a single line of SQL.*

Q2

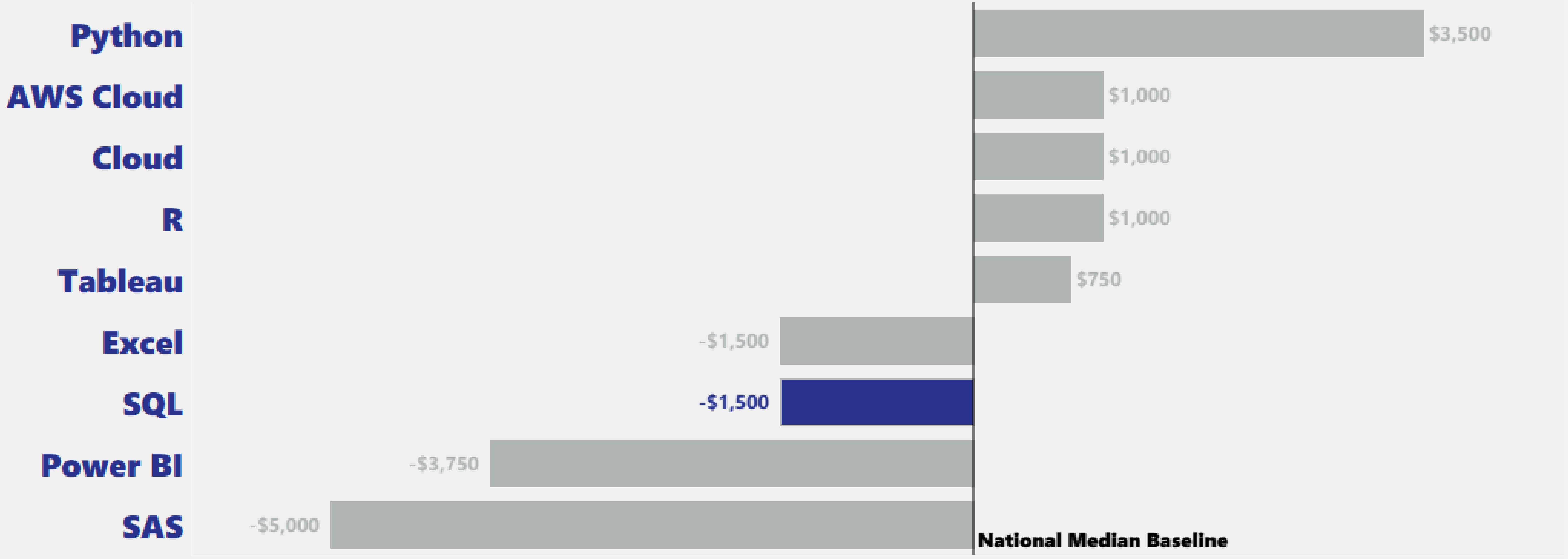
Which skills actually move your salary?

THE MYTH: SKILL

"**SQL is Enough** - it's the **most in-demand skill** of all postings and will **demand better pay**."

<u>Skill</u>: The “SQL premium” is a hoax.

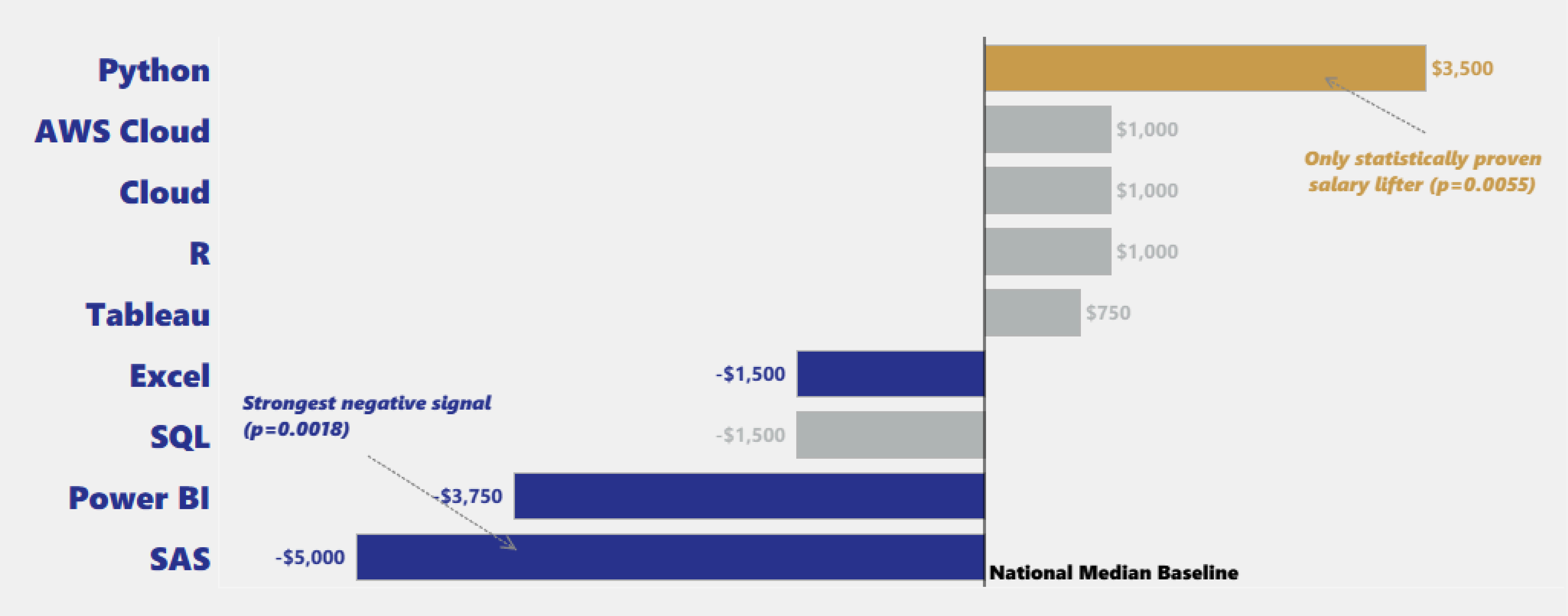
SQL alone carries a **-$1,500 salary penalty** (p=0.0018)



“Only statistically significant bars (p<0.05 are colored | Mann - Whiteney U Test | n = 2,251”

Your Resume Skills Send a Signal Before You Do

What actually **moves** your **salary**?



"Only statistically significant bars (p<0.05 are colored | Mann - Whiteney U Test | n = 2,251"

Q2

Which skills actually move your salary?

YES, SKILLS MOVE YOUR SALARY.
SKILLS DETERMINE YOUR VALUE.

*Your **skills** in **Python** can increase your value by **$3,500** a year vs other skills.*

Q3

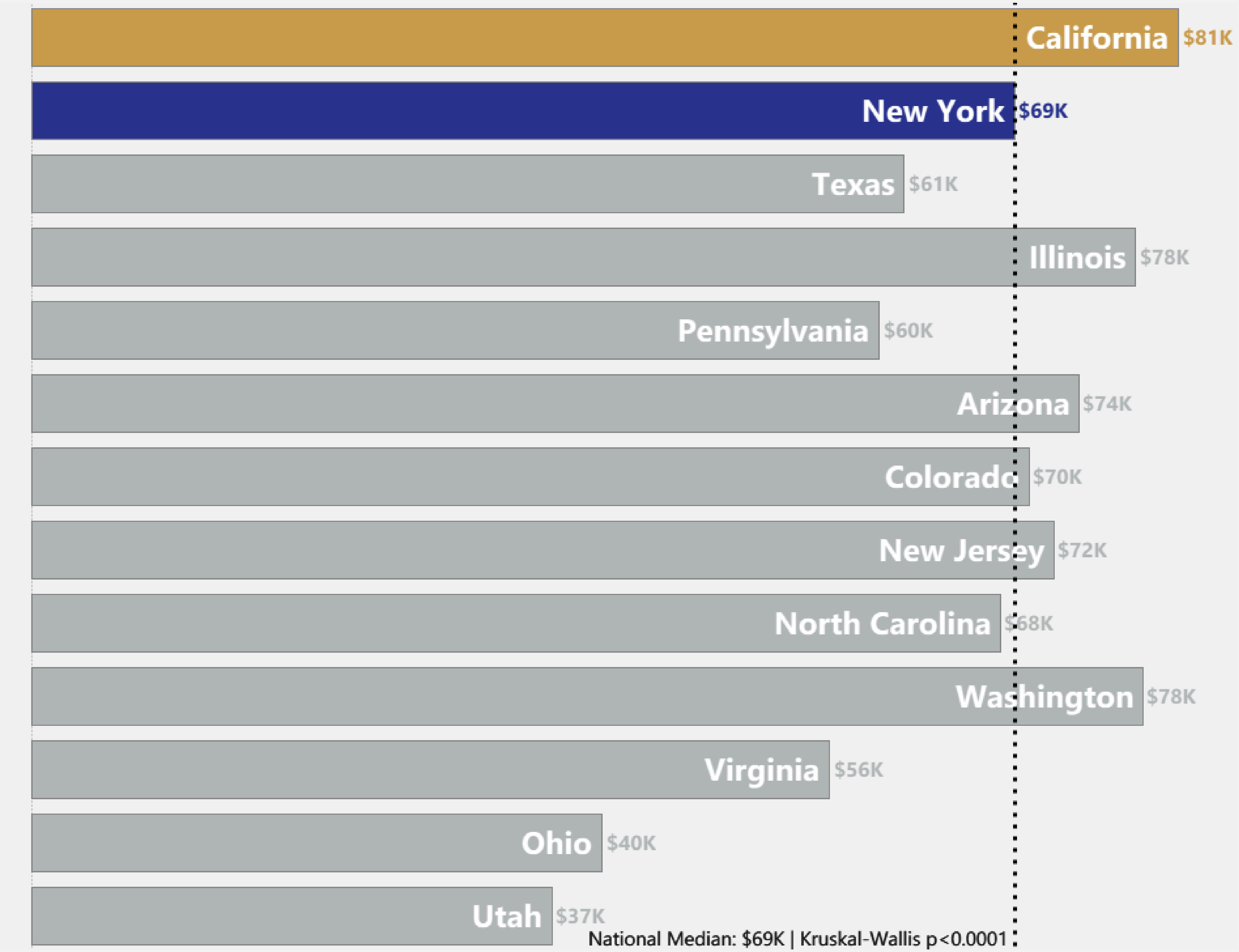
Does company site change the equation?

THE MYTH: SITE

"Move to California. Tech hubs always pay more.
Company Site is everything”

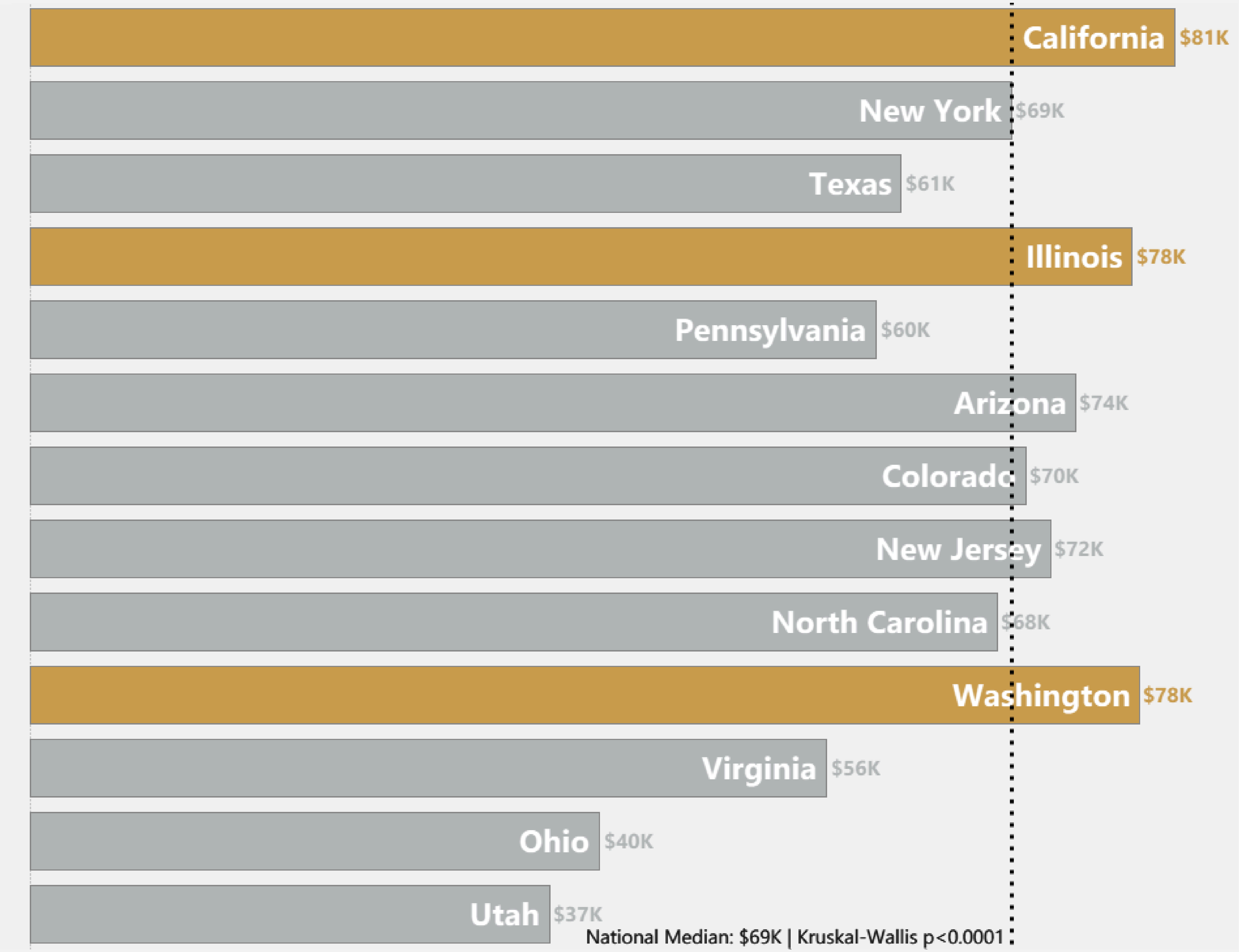
Site: California Is Real. New York Is a Myth.

California has a **$12K premium** while **New York** sits right at the $69K median.



Want a site premium?

CA, WA, and IL are the only states with confirmed **double-digit premiums.**



Q3

Does company site change the equation?

YES, CHASE GEOGRAPHIC PREMIUM.
SITE DETERMINES YOUR PAY.

Certain states can increase your salary by a double-digit premium.

Everything the Market Told You About Salary Was WRONG.

- **SECTOR: "Target IT - most jobs"**
  Crowded and median ($70k)
- **SKILL: "SQL is enough"**
  Does not drive a premium (-$1,500)
- **SITE: "Move to New York"**
  Zero premium ($69,000)

3S: The Evidence-Based Playbook

These steps don't add up — they multiply. A Python-skilled analyst in Biotech in California operates in a completely different salary universe.

01 CHOOSE SECTOR FIRST

Biotech, Telecom, or niche sectors. Avoid chasing volume. Avoid IT unless targeting California

Impact: 16% salary lift from sector choice

02 BUILD PYTHON SKILLS

The only proven salary lifter. Audit what you include: Python = premium signal.

Impact: 5% additional lift from skill stack

03 TARGET SITE PREMIUM

CA, WA, IL only for premium. Remote? Anchor salary to employer's HQ city.

Impact: 6% lift from company size choice

$50k gap. That salary gap follows patterns: Sector, Skills, Site.

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$50K gap

Analyst B

$92,000

Sector	**Biotech**
Site	**California**
Skills	**Python + SQL**

YOU NOW HAVE WHAT MOST APPLICANTS DON'T:

EVIDENCE.

630,000+ data analyst applications submitted every year in the US.
Most of them are optimizing for the wrong variables.

The next offer you receive - you'll know it's fair.